EXTREME FAT LOSS: Lose 10 lbs in 30 Days

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Oct 15, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RS_4DbP-igY Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

A 27-year certified trainer and nutritionist lays out an extreme but specific 30-day fat-loss protocol combining maxed-out daily walking (NEAT), full-body weight training, a high-protein calorie deficit, GLP-1 peptides, creatine, and caffeine.

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🔢 The Math of Fat Loss & The Four Calorie-Burn Levers 0:46

- Fat loss is pure math: burn more calories than you consume
  - Every pound of fat requires a **3,500-calorie deficit**
- There are four distinct ways the body burns calories:

Lever	What It Is	% of Daily Burn
BMR	Calories burned just staying alive	60–70%
Thermogenic Effect of Food (TEF)	Calories burned digesting food	8–10%
Exercise	Traditional workouts/cardio	5–15%
NEAT	Non-exercise movement (fidgeting, walking, etc.)	15–30%

- NEAT is the lever with the most controllable upside
  - Unlike exercise, NEAT doesn't require recovery, so it can be ramped up far more aggressively
  - Brandon argues NEAT is more powerful than traditional cardio for this reason

🚶 Pillar 1: 20,000 Steps Per Day (NEAT) 1:57

- The protocol requires exactly **20,000 steps every single day**
- Caloric payoff: the average person burns **800–1,000 extra calories per day** at 20,000 steps
  - 1,000 calories/day × 7 days = **10,000 calories/week = ~2 lbs of fat per week**
  - Over 4 weeks that equals **~8 lbs of fat from walking alone**
- Recommended daily schedule to hit 20,000 steps without a single long exhausting session:
  - Wake up → walk 30 minutes = ~3,000 steps
  - Lunch break → eat for 30 minutes, walk for 30 minutes = ~3,000 steps
  - After work → walk for 1 hour = ~6,000 steps
  - During work hours → set an alarm every hour and walk for 10 minutes (around the office or the block) = remaining ~8,000 steps
- Key reason to space walks out: doing 20,000 steps in one session may require recovery; spread throughout the day it feels manageable

🏋️ Pillar 2: Full-Body Weight Training 3–4x Per Week 3:53

- Do **3–4 full-body workouts per week** (Brandon has used this approach exclusively for 10+ years)
- Workout structure:
  - Pick 1–2 exercises per body part
  - Do 3–4 sets of each exercise
  - Each session should take **60–90 minutes max**
- Rest periods: time every rest with a watch (e.g., Apple Watch voice command — "Set 90-second timer")
  - Use **60–90 second rest intervals** between sets
- **Superset opposing muscle groups** to speed up the session and burn more calories:
  - Chest + Back (example: bench press → immediately into bent-over rows, then rest, repeat)
  - Biceps + Triceps
  - Legs are done straight (no opposing superset) — squats or leg press only
- Prioritize **compound movements** exclusively (with minor exceptions for extremities):
  - Compound: bench press, bent-over rows, overhead press, leg press, pull-ups, squats, dips
  - Isolation allowed only for extremities: bicep curls, tricep extensions, calf raises
  - Reason: compound movements deliver the most muscle size and caloric burn
- Note for beginners: if you have trained less than 1 year, you may be able to **build muscle and burn fat simultaneously** on this protocol — a benefit that disappears after the first year of consistent training

🍗 Pillar 3: Diet — Calories & Protein 5:46

- **Calorie target: current bodyweight (lbs) × 10 = daily calories**

- Example: 200 lb person eats 2,000 calories/day
- Use *current* bodyweight, not goal bodyweight

- **Protein target: minimum 1 gram per pound of current bodyweight**
  - Brandon personally eats 250–300 g of protein/day at 197 lbs
  - Skipping this causes muscle wasting and bone density loss — especially dangerous in a deep deficit
- Why protein is the "cheat code" macro — three compounding advantages:
  - **Highest thermogenic effect**: body burns 20–30% of protein calories just digesting it
    - Protein digestion burns **3× more calories than fat digestion** and **2× more than carb digestion**
    - Eating 100 calories of protein → body only absorbs 70–80 of those calories
  - Preserves lean muscle during aggressive cuts
  - Most satiating macronutrient — keeps hunger lower
- Fats vs. carbs: **no specific prescription** — allocate remaining calories however you prefer
  - Brandon has been keto for 11 years but explicitly says high-carb works too
  - "Get your protein and your calories straight. You're going to be all right."

💊 Pillar 4: GLP-1 Peptide (Tirzepatide) + Calorie Tracking 11:09

- **Consult your doctor before attempting this** — Brandon stresses this repeatedly and notes he is not a medical professional
- Brandon has been on **tirzepatide** for several months and calls it the most powerful fat-loss tool he has seen in nearly 30 years in the industry
  - Key effects: **zero hunger, complete elimination of cravings**
  - Made his summer cut "the easiest cut I've ever done in my life"
- Analogy: dieting without a GLP-1 is like researching a school report via the Dewey Decimal System and typing on a typewriter; dieting with tirzepatide is like using an iPad with AI
- Critical warning when using GLP-1s: **you must still force yourself to hit protein and calorie targets**
  - Suppressed hunger can cause accidental starvation → muscle wasting, bone density loss
  - Tracking calories is non-negotiable
- **Calorie tracking method:** Brandon uses **Claude (AI)** — takes a photo of food or describes it verbally; Claude keeps a running daily log and gives a macro breakdown at end of day
  - Example cut day: 1,700 calories, 207 g protein, 40 g net carbs, 77 g fat → 1,500-calorie deficit
  - Brandon offers a free prompt for this in the video description
- Observation: "Everyone I know who tracks their calories is in amazing shape. Everyone I know who doesn't, looks like it."

🥤 Pillar 5: Supplements — Creatine, Caffeine & Protein Shakes 15:40

- **Protein shakes**

    - Not magic, but have one of the best calorie-to-protein ratios available
    - Essential tool for keeping calories low while hitting high protein targets
    - On a heavy cut, Brandon eats two meals (breakfast and dinner) and fills gaps with shakes
- **Creatine**
    - Brandon takes **20 g/day** — well above the standard 5 g muscle-building dose
    - Rationale for higher dose: benefits beyond muscle — improved brain health and mood
    - Also helps **maintain muscle mass** during a deep caloric deficit
    - "Literally everyone should take creatine, even if you're not working out"
- **Caffeine**
    - Needed for energy during high-step, high-training, low-calorie protocol
    - Proven to aid fat burning
    - Brandon's personal intake: **600–1,000 mg/day** (he acknowledges this is extreme and has been building tolerance since high school)
    - Recommended personal schedule:
        - 300 mg at the start of the day
        - Another 300 mg after lunch, before the midday walk
        - Pre-workout before gym session
    - Take as much as works for you individually — no single prescription given

💉 Pillar 6: Tesamorelin Peptide 18:19

- Again: **talk to your doctor** — obtain via prescription only, not shady websites
- **Tesamorelin** is an FDA-studied peptide shown to **reduce belly fat** (originally tested in HIV patients)
- Brandon's personal results: noticeably improved ab definition, which he attributes to the combination of tesamorelin, diet, and training
- Bonus benefit he didn't expect: **dramatically improved sleep quality**
    - "I have never slept better in my life" — confirmed by Oura Ring sleep data
    - Says he would take it for the sleep benefit alone even if fat loss weren't a factor

✅ Closing Thoughts & Accountability 19:31

- Brandon expresses confidence that following all five pillars can produce **10 lbs of fat loss in 30 days**
- The hard part is execution, not knowledge
    - "Watching videos is easy."
    - Most people struggle even with easier plans — which is why online trainers and accountability coaches are valuable
- Full protocol summary:
    - 20,000 steps/day (spaced throughout the day)

- 3–4 full-body weight training sessions/week with compound movements and supersets
- Calories = bodyweight × 10; protein ≥ 1 g per lb of bodyweight
- Track all food (AI or app)
- GLP-1 peptide (tirzepatide) — doctor's prescription required
- Creatine (20 g/day), caffeine (to tolerance), protein shakes to hit targets
- Tesamorelin — doctor's prescription required

> "You cannot out-train a bad diet. But you can out-diet bad training. Diet is actually going to be the biggest lever we can pull."